NARRATIVE

NARRATIVE STRATEGIES/535 NEWS MIDTERM VOTER POLL

METHODOLOGY

The survey was conducted by Narrative Strategies online among a national sample of voter file-verified midterm voters using non-probability sampling. Respondents were recruited through an online sample exchange using demographic quotas to ensure balance across key groups based on public estimates of the likely electorate. Quotas were set for gender, age, race/ethnicity, region, urban/rural residence, and education to approximate the composition of the likely electorate. Measures to ensure data quality included steps to prevent duplicate responses, screening questions designed to identify inattentive respondents, and the removal of respondents who completed a substantial portion of the survey significantly faster than typical.

The final sample was weighted to the profile of the 2026 midterm electorate, as measured by the Voter Poll by SSRS. Weights adjust for 2026 U.S. House vote, age, gender, race and ethnicity, education, party identification, ideology, union household, and household income. DEM reflects Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents, and GOP reflects Republicans and Republican-leaning independents. All respondents were matched to the voter file. Percentages may not sum to 100% because of rounding or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Because this survey uses a non-probability sample, a traditional margin of sampling error does not strictly apply. A comparable estimate, adjusted for weighting, is ±3.0 percentage points for the national sample. This survey was fielded among N=1,006 registered voters nationwide, including 499 Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents and 427 Republicans and Republican-leaning independents. The survey was fielded from October 24 - November 3, 2026.

ISSUES, COSTS, AND ENERGY

Q1. Which issues were most important in determining your vote? Select up to three.

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Inflation and the cost of living	**63%**	**64%**	**63%**
Jobs and the economy	**35%**	**35%**	**35%**
Democracy and government accountability	**30%**	**42%**	19%
Healthcare	27%	34%	22%
Immigration	22%	12%	**33%**
Housing costs	17%	15%	18%
Electricity and utility costs	17%	12%	22%
Crime and public safety	16%	11%	20%

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Abortion	10%	11%	9%
Education	9%	11%	8%
Data center development	9%	8%	10%
Artificial intelligence	8%	9%	6%
Foreign affairs	6%	7%	5%
Energy policy	4%	3%	5%
Something else (Please specify)	5%	6%	4%

ONLY SHOWN TO RESPONDENTS WHO SELECTED TWO OR THREE ISSUES IN Q1

Q2. And, which one of the following issues was MOST important in determining your vote?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Inflation and the cost of living	**40%**	**40%**	**42%**
Democracy and government accountability	17%	27%	7%
Jobs and the economy	8%	6%	9%
Healthcare	8%	8%	8%
Immigration	7%	2%	12%
Abortion	3%	3%	4%
Crime and public safety	3%	2%	5%
Electricity and utility costs	3%	1%	3%
Housing costs	2%	2%	2%
Data center development	2%	1%	2%
Education	2%	2%	1%
Artificial intelligence	1%	1%	<1%
Foreign affairs	1%	0%	2%
Energy policy	<1%	0%	1%
OTHER	3%	4%	2%

RECONCILED TOP ISSUE AMONG THOSE WHO SELECTED JUST ONE ISSUE IN Q1 AND THE TOP ISSUE SELECTED IN Q2

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Inflation and the cost of living	**38%**	**38%**	**40%**
Democracy and government accountability	18%	29%	7%
Jobs and the economy	9%	7%	9%
Healthcare	8%	8%	8%
Immigration	7%	2%	12%
Abortion	3%	3%	4%
Crime and public safety	3%	1%	5%
Electricity and utility costs	3%	1%	3%
Housing costs	3%	2%	3%
Education	2%	3%	1%
Data center development	2%	1%	2%
Artificial intelligence	1%	1%	1%
Foreign affairs	1%	0%	1%
Energy policy	<1%	0%	1%
OTHER	4%	4%	2%

Q3. Which of the following costs concerns you most? Select up to three.

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Groceries	**67%**	**72%**	**62%**
Gasoline and transportation	**55%**	**54%**	**57%**
Electricity and utility bills	**39%**	39%	**39%**
Healthcare and prescription drugs	36%	**44%**	26%
Housing, including rent and mortgage payments	30%	32%	26%
Property taxes	23%	19%	28%
Interest payments and debt	12%	10%	16%
Childcare	3%	3%	3%
Something else (please specify)	4%	4%	5%
Not sure	1%	<1%	2%

Q4. Which of the following issues or events do you think are most responsible for rising costs? Select up to two.

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
The Iran war	**44%**	**55%**	**33%**
Tariffs	**38%**	**53%**	21%
Rising fuel and gas prices	30%	21%	**38%**
Price gouging and profiteering	20%	19%	21%
Government spending	19%	14%	22%
Unnecessary regulations	7%	4%	13%
Interest rates	7%	5%	10%
The Russia-Ukraine war	6%	7%	8%
Data center development	6%	7%	5%
Interruptions in the supply chain	4%	4%	5%
Strains on the electric grid	2%	2%	2%
Something else (please specify)	4%	2%	6%
Not sure	2%	1%	4%

LEADERSHIP AND PRIORITIES

Q5. If your party were to win the House of Representatives, which leadership approach would you prefer from the Speaker of the House?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
A leader who works with the other side to get things done, even if it means not getting everything they want	**71%**	**72%**	**69%**
A leader who stands firm on their partisan priorities, even if less gets done	19%	17%	22%
Not sure	10%	11%	9%

Q6. If your party were to win the U.S. Senate, which leadership approach would you prefer from the Majority Leader?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
A leader who works with the other side to get things done, even if it means not getting everything they want	**71%**	**70%**	**71%**
A leader who stands firm on their partisan priorities, even if less gets done	21%	22%	21%
Not sure	8%	8%	8%

Q7. Which of the following is the biggest obstacle to progress in Washington?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Elected officials unwilling to compromise	**22%**	18%	**25%**
Political extremism	19%	**19%**	19%
Special interests and lobbyists	15%	15%	14%
Partisan gridlock	12%	12%	11%
Corporate influence	11%	14%	9%
Government bureaucracy	11%	11%	13%
Something else (Please specify)	4%	6%	2%
Not sure	5%	5%	6%

Q8. Which of the following actions, if any, should be among the new Congress's top priorities during its first 100 days? Select up to two.

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Protect Social Security and Medicare benefits	**32%**	**33%**	**32%**
Reduce tariffs on imported goods	**20%**	**31%**	11%
Reduce federal spending and the national debt	19%	12%	**27%**
Pass stronger ethics and anti-corruption rules for federal officials	17%	23%	10%
Provide tax relief for low- and middle-income households	17%	13%	21%
Set limits on U.S. military involvement in Iran	16%	22%	8%
Require large electricity users, including data centers, to pay for the grid upgrades needed to meet their electricity demand	12%	9%	14%
Expand assistance to help people afford health insurance	11%	15%	7%
Establish national rules for the development and use of artificial intelligence	10%	10%	10%
Increase funding for border security and immigration enforcement	9%	3%	16%
Expand job training and apprenticeship programs	5%	4%	7%
Make it easier to build housing	5%	5%	5%
Speed up approval of new electricity generation and transmission projects	4%	4%	5%
Something else (please specify)	3%	3%	3%
None of these	<1%	<1%	1%
Not sure	3%	3%	4%

ASKED OF REPUBLICANS AND REPUBLICAN-LEANING INDEPENDENTS.

Q9. Looking ahead to the future of the Republican Party, which of the following should Republicans MOST continue from the Trump years?

Response	USA	GOP
Base (n)	*448*	*427*
Focus on lowering costs and strengthening the economy	**49%**	**49%**
Stronger immigration enforcement and border security	17%	17%
An America First trade agenda, including tariffs on foreign competitors	13%	13%
Taking on political and cultural institutions	6%	6%
Challenging Republican establishment leaders	5%	5%
Taking a more confrontational approach toward the national news media	3%	3%
Something else (Please specify)	2%	2%
Not sure	4%	4%

ELECTION

Q10. How have you voted/How do you plan to vote?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
By mail or absentee ballot	29%	33%	24%
In person early	31%	32%	30%
In person on election day	40%	34%	46%
Not sure	<1%	1%	<1%

Q11. Which candidate did you vote for / would you vote for (if the election were held today) in the 2026 election for the U.S. House of Representatives?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
The Republican candidate	43%	3%	92%
The Democratic candidate	55%	97%	7%
Another candidate	2%	<1%	1%
Did not vote / do not plan to vote in that race	<1%	0%	<1%

Q12. Thinking about your vote for the U.S. House of Representatives, was it mainly a...

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Vote FOR the party of the candidate I chose	53%	48%	60%
Vote AGAINST the other party	17%	18%	13%
Equally both	27%	30%	24%
Not sure	3%	4%	3%

Q13. When did you decide how you were going to vote in the 2026 election for the U.S. House of Representatives?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Before October	60%	64%	57%
The first two weeks of October	14%	12%	15%
The last two weeks of October	14%	14%	15%
The final days in November before Election Day	8%	6%	10%
Not sure	4%	4%	3%

DEMOGRAPHICS

S1. People have many reasons for voting or not voting. Have you already voted in the election, or have you been unable to vote yet, like many others? If you haven't yet voted, how likely are you to vote by the end of election day, November 3, 2026?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Already voted	39%	42%	36%
Definitely will vote	61%	58%	64%

S2. What gender do you identify with?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Male	46%	44%	48%
Female	54%	56%	52%
Prefer to self-describe	0%	0%	0%

S3. What is your age?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
18-34	17%	20%	13%
35-49	23%	19%	25%
50-64	26%	26%	27%
65+	35%	35%	35%

S4. What is your race or ethnicity? Select all that apply.

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Hispanic	10%	13%	7%
Black, non-Hispanic	9%	15%	2%
Asian, non-Hispanic	4%	4%	4%
Native Hawaiian or Pacific Islander	<1%	0%	<1%
Other / 2+ races, non-Hispanic	5%	6%	3%
White, non-Hispanic	72%	62%	83%

S5. Generally speaking, do you usually think of yourself as a Republican, a Democrat, an Independent, or something else?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Republican	32%	0%	75%
Democrat	35%	71%	0%
Independent	33%	29%	25%
Something else	<1%	<1%	0%
Not sure	<1%	0%	0%

ASKED OF RESPONDENTS WHO DO NOT IDENTIFY AS A REPUBLICAN OR A DEMOCRAT.

S6. Which party do you agree with more often on issues that are important to you?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Base (n)	*222*	*96*	*50*
The Republican Party	32%	0%	100%
The Democratic Party	44%	100%	0%
Both equally	11%	0%	0%
Neither	12%	0%	0%
Not sure	1%	0%	0%

Party identification (consolidated from S7 and S8)

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Republican / Republican-leaning	42%	0%	100%
Democratic / Democratic-leaning	50%	100%	0%
Independent / Other / Unsure	8%	0%	0%

S7. What is the last grade you completed in school?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Some high school or less	1%	1%	2%
High school graduate	21%	22%	21%
Technical or vocational school graduate	4%	3%	5%
Some college, no degree	15%	14%	15%
Associate's degree	12%	10%	14%
Bachelor's degree	27%	29%	25%
Postgraduate degree	20%	21%	18%
Prefer not to say	<1%	<1%	0%

D1. How would you describe the area where you live?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Urban	27%	30%	24%
Suburban	47%	51%	43%
Small town not near a city	8%	6%	11%
Rural	17%	12%	23%

D2. What was your total household income from all sources, before taxes, in 2025?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Less than $30,000	12%	13%	10%
$30,000–$49,999	14%	12%	18%
$50,000–$74,999	19%	17%	21%
$75,000–$99,999	13%	14%	11%
$100,000–$149,999	22%	24%	22%
$150,000–$199,999	10%	10%	9%
$200,000 or more	9%	9%	9%
Prefer not to say	<1%	<1%	0%

D3. For whom did you vote in the 2024 presidential election?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Donald Trump	44%	5%	92%
Kamala Harris	51%	91%	5%
Someone else	3%	3%	2%
Did not vote / do not plan to vote in that race	2%	2%	<1%
Prefer not to say	<1%	0%	<1%

D4. Would you say your political beliefs are…

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Very liberal	13%	24%	1%
Somewhat liberal	13%	25%	1%
Moderate	41%	45%	29%
Somewhat conservative	17%	4%	34%
Very conservative	16%	2%	35%

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Not sure	<1%	<1%	0%

ASKED OF REPUBLICANS AND REPUBLICAN-LEANING INDEPENDENTS.

D5. Do you consider yourself part of the Make America Great Again movement, or MAGA?

Response	USA	GOP
Base (n)	*448*	*427*
Yes	49%	49%
No	51%	51%

ASKED OF DEMOCRATS AND DEMOCRATIC-LEANING INDEPENDENTS.

D6. Do you consider yourself part of the Democratic Socialists of America, or DSA?

Response	USA	DEM
Base (n)	*558*	*499*
Yes	19%	22%
No	81%	78%

D7. What is your current employment status?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Employed full-time	39%	39%	40%
Employed part-time	7%	7%	7%
Self employed	7%	8%	4%
Looking for work / unemployed	7%	7%	6%
Homemaker	6%	4%	8%
Student	1%	2%	1%
Retired	33%	32%	34%
Prefer not to answer	<1%	<1%	<1%

D8. Are you or is a member of your household a member of a labor union? Select all that apply.

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Yes, I am	11%	12%	10%
Yes, someone in my household is	6%	7%	3%
No	85%	83%	87%
Not sure	<1%	<1%	1%

ASKED OF RESPONDENTS IN A UNION HOUSEHOLD.

D9. Is that labor union in the public sector, the private sector, or both?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Base (n)	*120*	*67*	*42*
Public sector	60%	61%	57%
Private sector	28%	29%	29%
Both	6%	5%	2%
Not sure	6%	5%	11%

D10. Which of the following best describes the kind of work you do or did most recently?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Professional or managerial work	26%	29%	22%
Office or administrative work	17%	17%	17%
Service work	10%	10%	9%
Sales work	9%	9%	10%
Skilled trade or construction work	5%	4%	7%
Manufacturing or production work	6%	4%	7%
Transportation or delivery work	3%	3%	4%
Agricultural work	1%	<1%	1%
Something else (please specify)	17%	17%	17%
I have never been employed	4%	4%	4%
Prefer not to say	2%	2%	2%

D11. Do you consider yourself working class, middle class, upper class, or something else?

Response	USA	DEM	GOP
Working class	33%	35%	30%
Middle class	58%	58%	57%
Upper class	5%	4%	6%
Something else (please specify)	3%	2%	3%
Not sure	2%	1%	3%